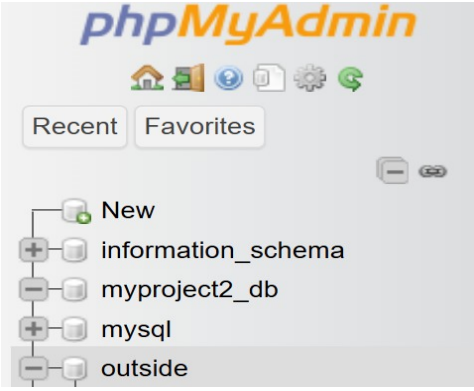
Task 1: Setup WordPress on XAMPP

Step 1: Open **XAMPP** Control Panel. Start Apache and MySQL. Both should turn green.

Step 2: Go to: **localhost/phpmyadmin**

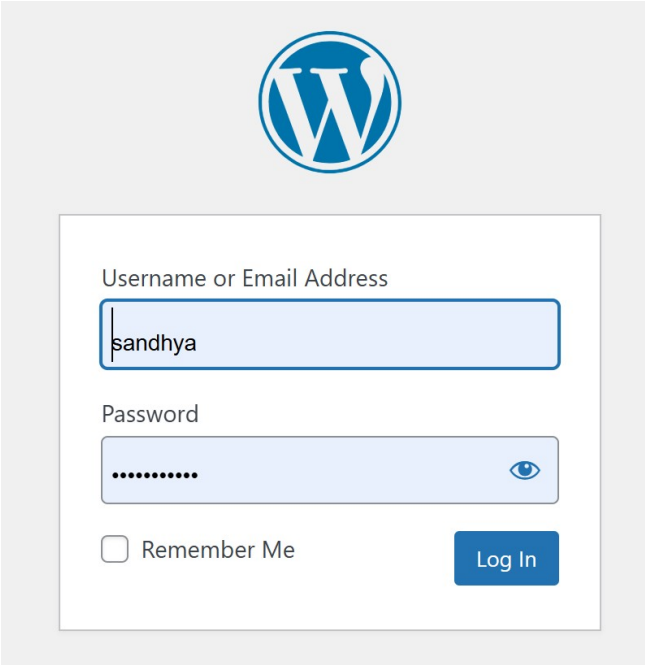
Step 3: Create a new database named "**outside**".

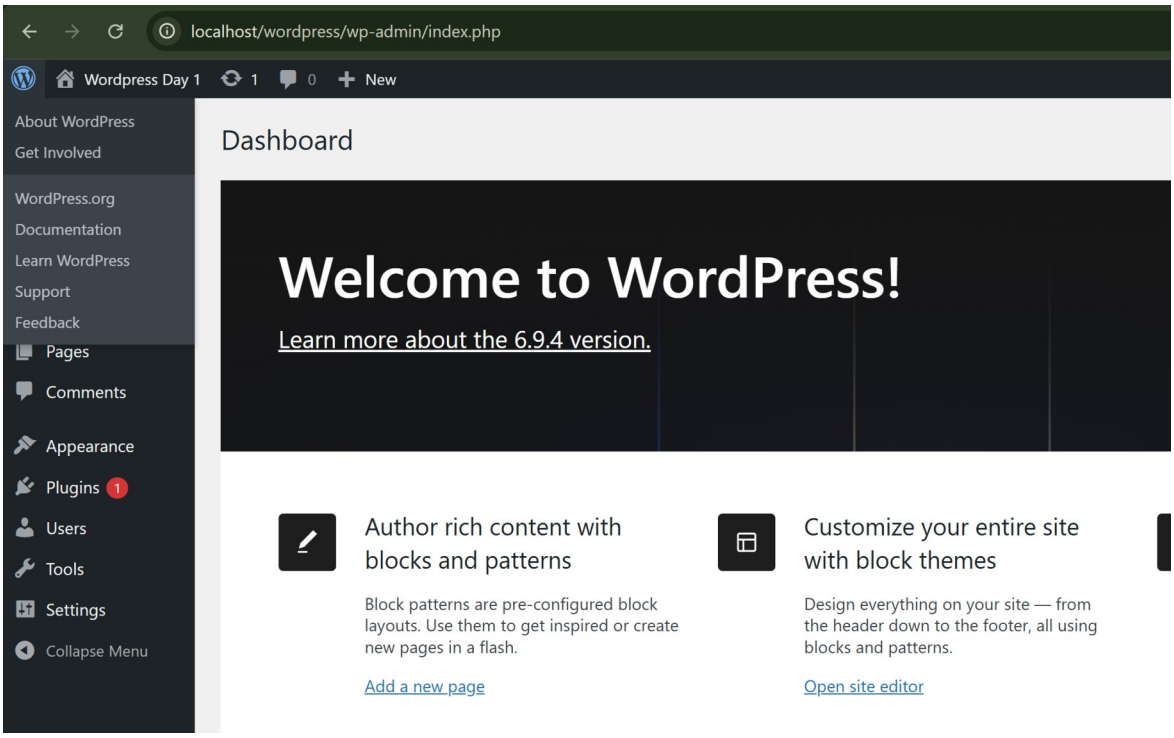


Step 4: Go to wordpress.org, download WordPress, and extract the folder inside C:/xampp/htdocs/.

Step 5: Go to **localhost/wordpress**. Fill in the database name, username (root), leave password blank, and click Submit.

Step 6: Log in and we will see the WordPress Dashboard.





Task 2: What is LocalWP and How to Set It Up

LocalWP is a free app that sets up WordPress on our computer automatically. There is no need of manual database or server setup.

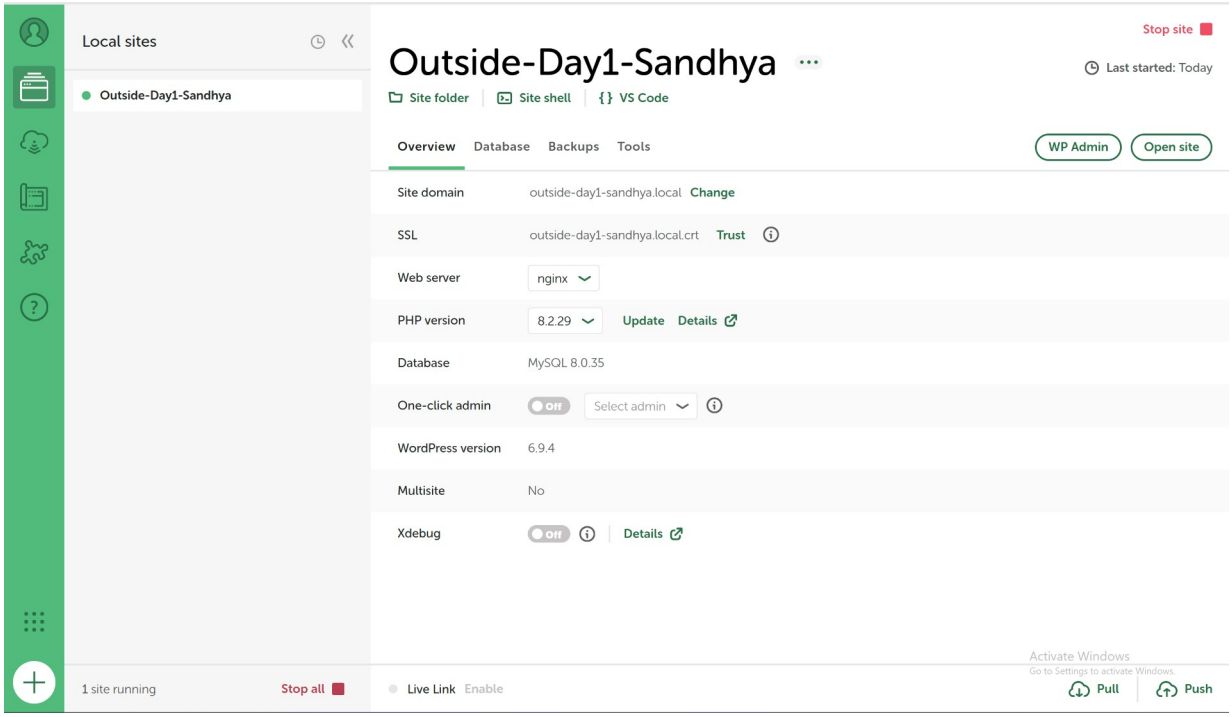
Step 1: Download and install the app through **localwp.com**.

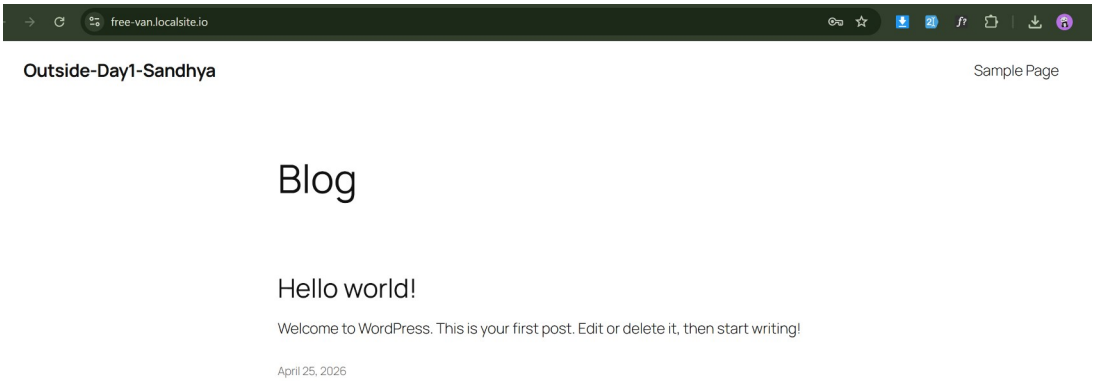
Step 2: Open LocalWP. Click the + button to create a new site.

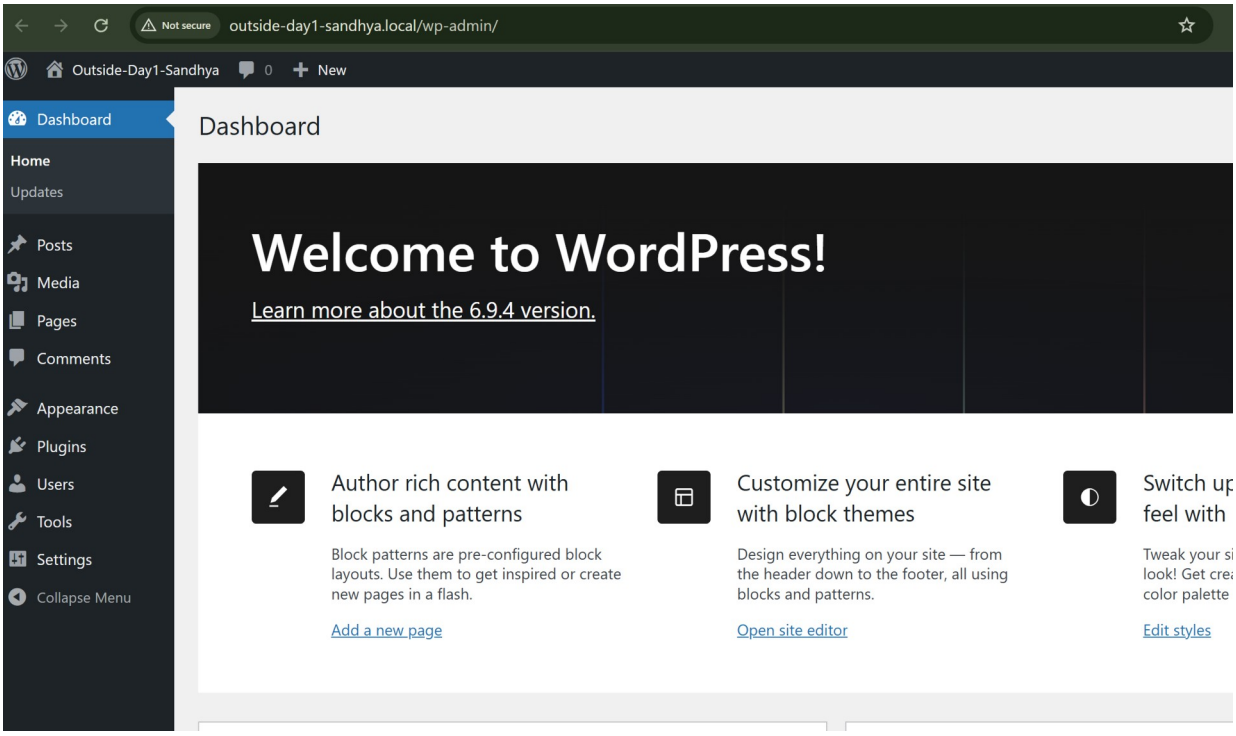
Step 3: Type a site name (eg. Outside-Day1-Sandhya). Click Continue.

Step 4: Enter an admin username and password. Click Add Site.

Step 6: LocalWP will create the site. Once done, we will see it listed. Click Open Site to view it in browser. Click Open Admin to go to the dashboard.

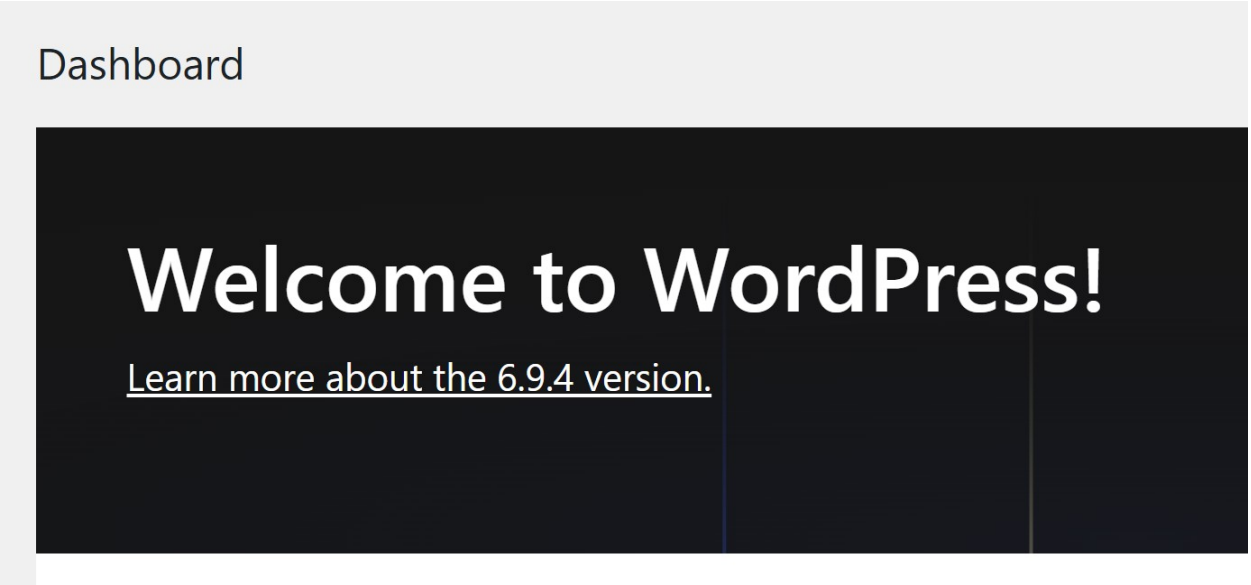



free-van.localsite.io
Outside-Day1-Sandhya
Sample Page
Blog
Hello world!
Welcome to WordPress. This is your first post. Edit or delete it, then start writing!
April 25, 2026

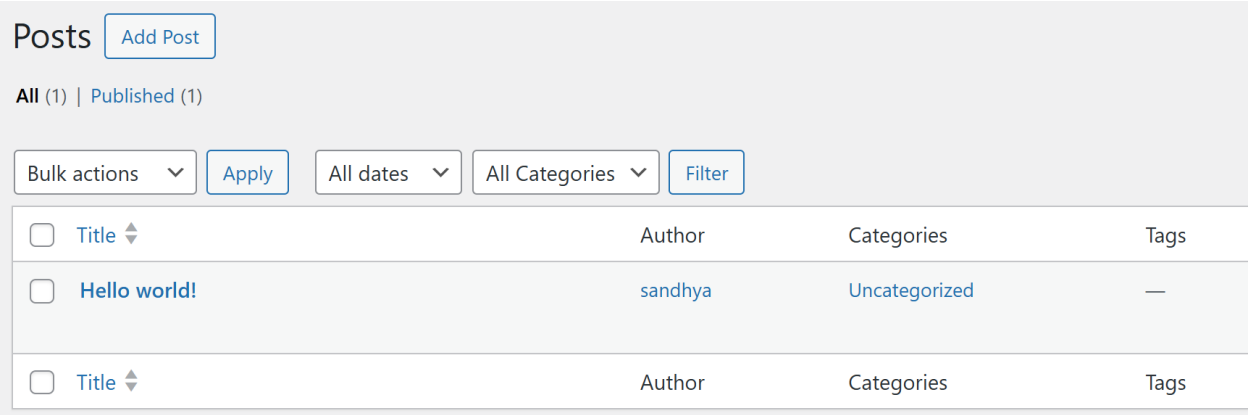

Not secure
outside-day1-sandhya.local/wp-admin/
Outside-Day1-Sandhya
0
New
Dashboard
Home
Updates
Posts
Media
Pages
Comments
Appearance
Plugins
Users
Tools
Settings
Collapse Menu
Dashboard
Welcome to WordPress!
Learn more about the 6.9.4 version.
Author rich content with blocks and patterns
Block patterns are pre-configured block layouts. Use them to get inspired or create new pages in a flash.
Add a new page
Customize your entire site with block themes
Design everything on your site — from the header down to the footer, all using blocks and patterns.
Open site editor
Edit styles

Task 3: Exploring the WordPress Dashboard

Step 1: Go to dashboard. This is the first screen we see after logging in.



Step 2: Click Posts on the left menu. We will see all our posts here.



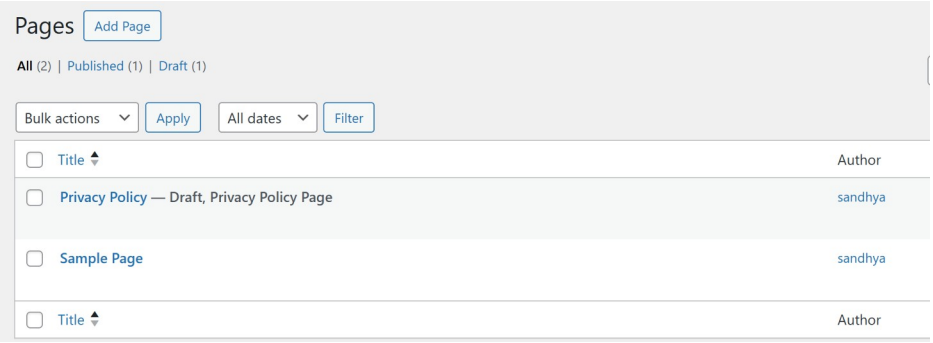
Step 3: Click Add New Post. Write a title, add some text, choose a category, and click Publish.

Outside

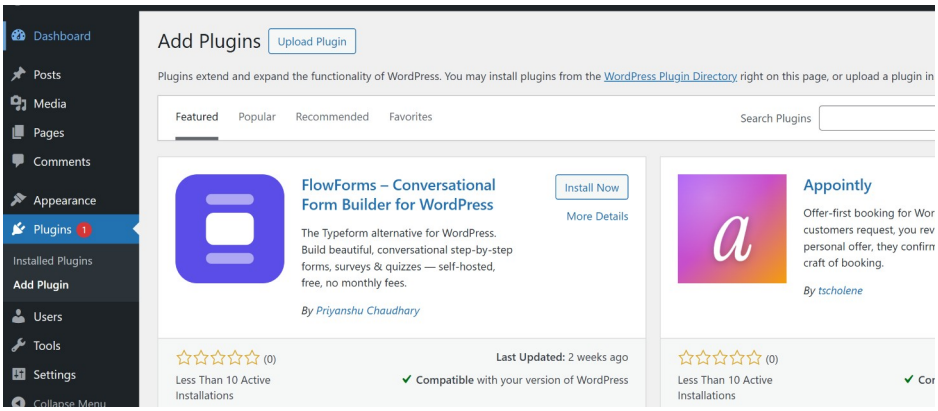
Written by sandhya in Traineeship

Trainee – Sandhya Shiwakoti

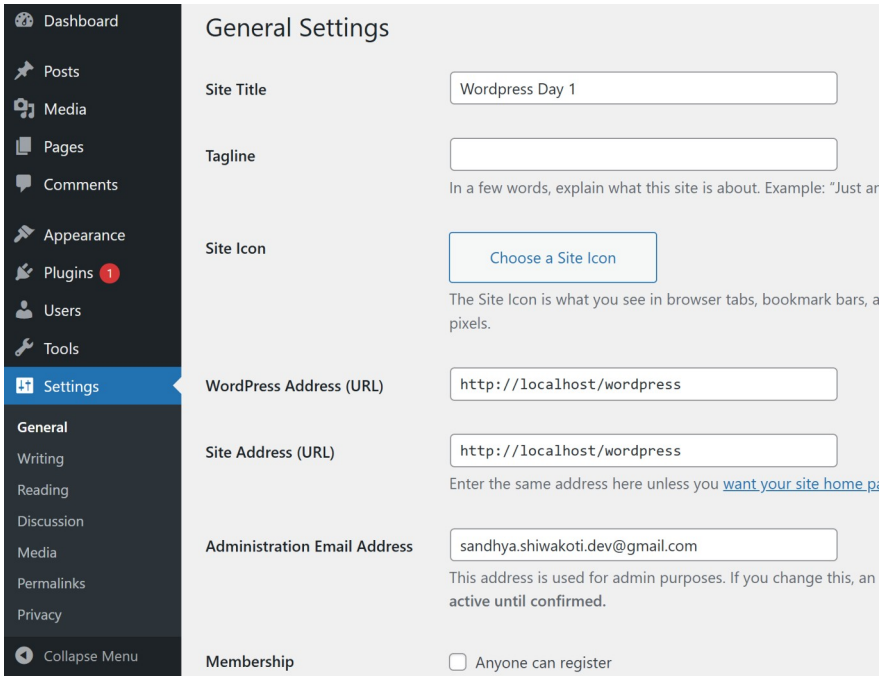
Step 4: Click Pages on the left menu.



Step 5: Click Plugins on the left menu. We will see all installed plugins.



Step 6: Click Settings → General. We can see the site title, timezone, and other settings here.

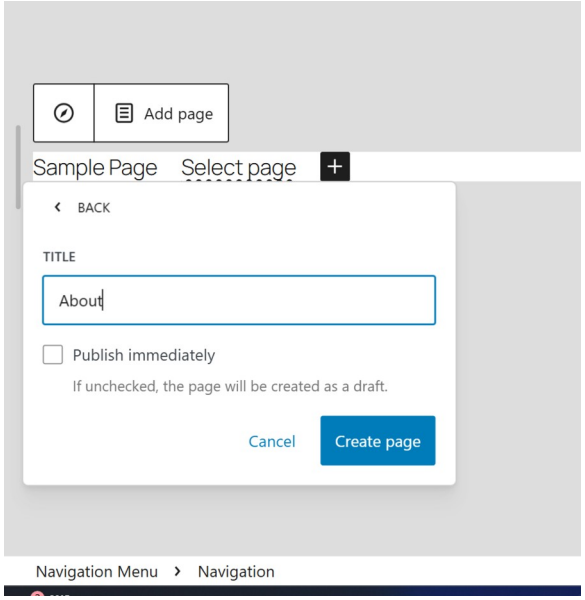


Task 4: Exploring Nav Menus

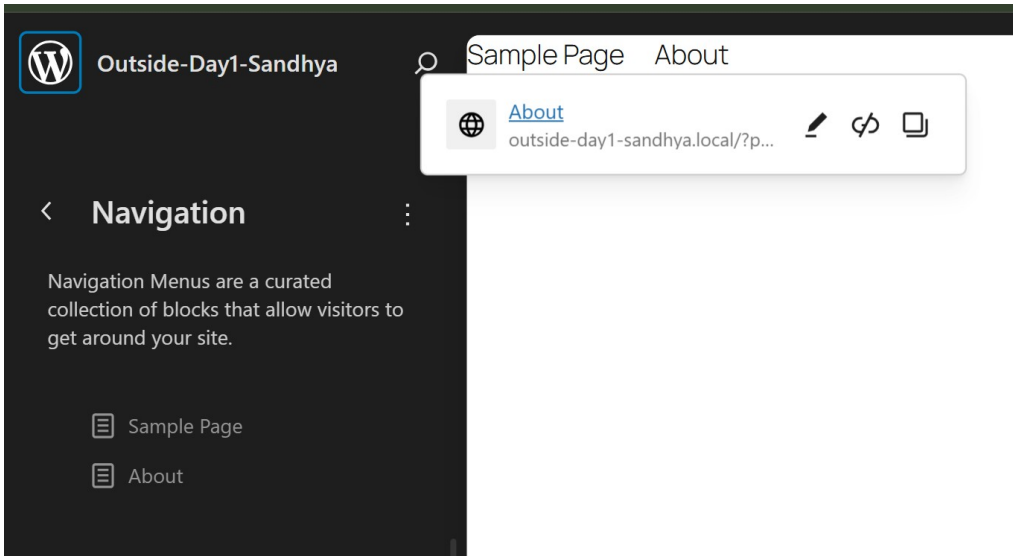
Nav menus are the navigation links at the top of our website that help visitors go from page to page.

Step 1: In dashboard, go to Appearance → Theme/Editor → Navigation Menu.

Step 2: Click the three dots ⋮ next to Navigation and create page (eg. About).



Step 3: The page gets added to the menu

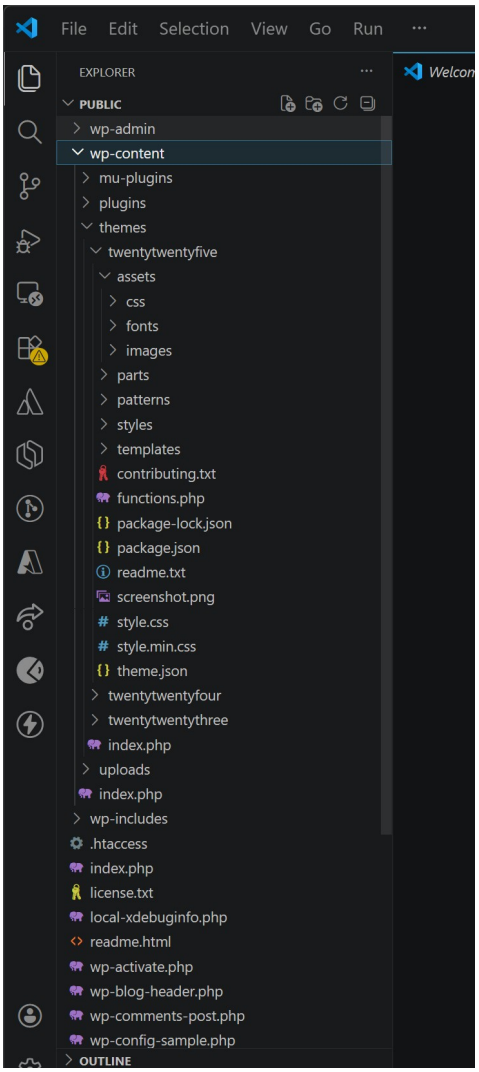


Task 5: Theme Development – File Structure and Template Hierarchy

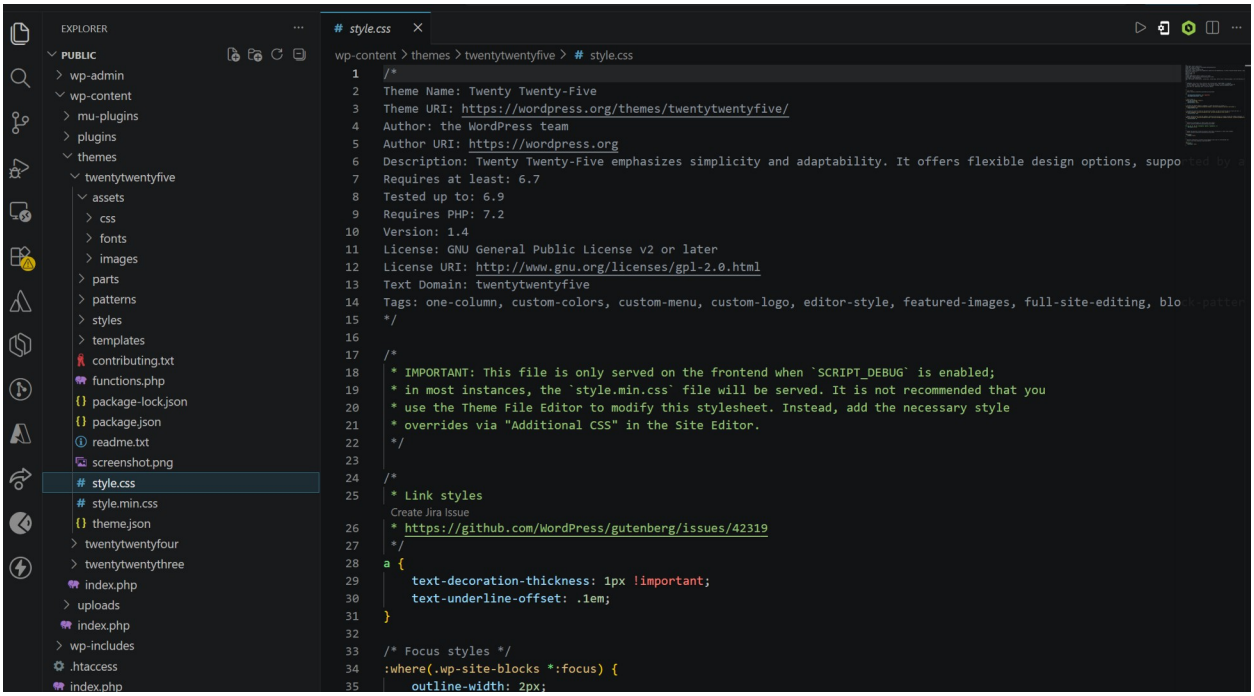
Themes control how our WordPress site looks. Each theme has a specific set of files.

Step 1: Open VS Code. Navigate to WordPress folder → wp-content → themes. We will see the theme folders inside.

Step 2: Open one of the theme folders. We will see files like style.css, index.php, functions.php etc.



Step 3: Open style.css. At the top we will see the theme name, author, and version written as comments.



Theme File Structure - What I Understood

A WordPress theme controls how a website looks, not the content. So even if we change the theme, all posts and pages stay the same. All theme files are stored inside wp-content/themes/ folder. Each theme has its own folder inside there.

The main files and what they do:

style.css - The main stylesheet of the theme. At the very top it contains the theme name, author, and version as a comment. WordPress reads this to identify the theme. All CSS styling is written below that.

functions.php - Works like a plugin for the theme. Used to add features like registering menus, loading scripts, and enabling theme support.

index.php - The main fallback template. If WordPress can't find any other matching file, it always uses this one.

templates folder - Contains different template files for different pages like home, single post, archive etc.

parts folder - Contains smaller reusable pieces like header and footer that are used inside the bigger templates.

theme.json - Controls global settings like colors, fonts, and spacing. Used in modern Full Site Editing themes like Twenty Twenty Five.

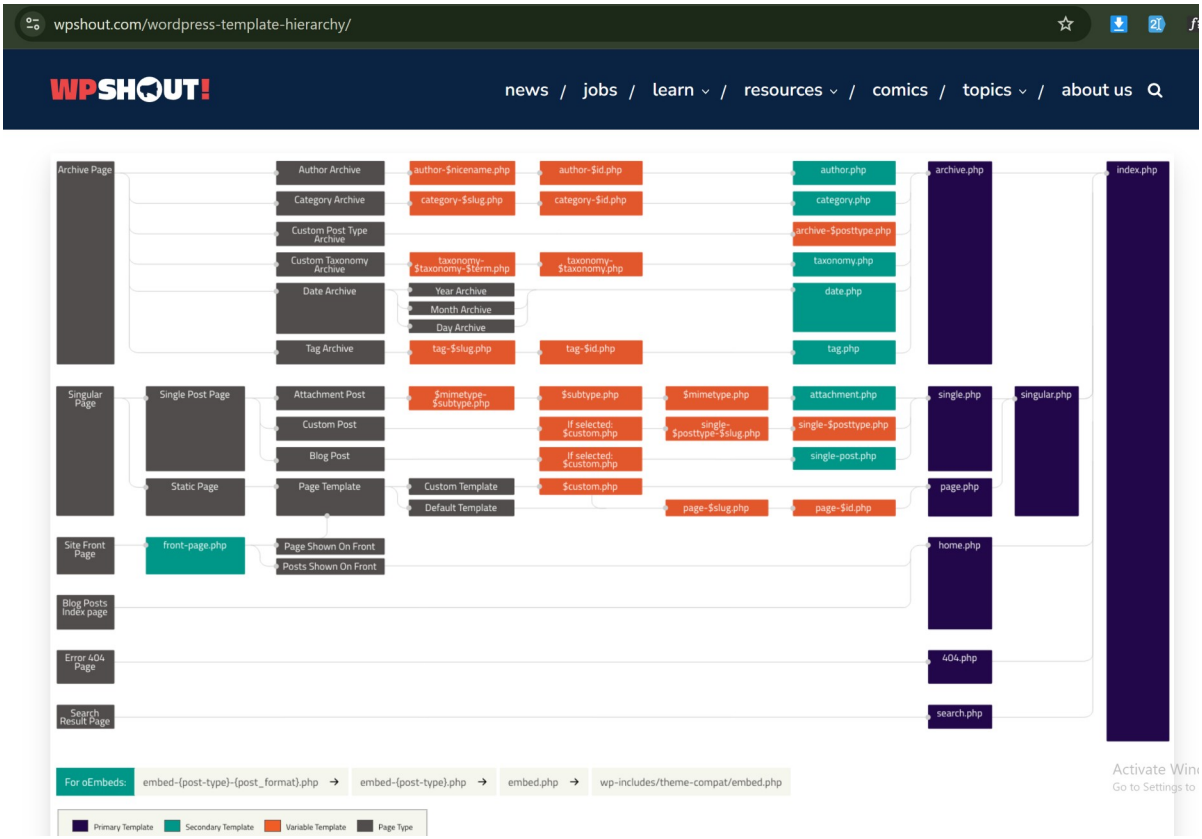
Template Hierarchy - What I Understood

Template hierarchy is the system WordPress uses to decide which template file to load. It always looks for the most specific file first. If that file doesn't exist, it moves to the next one. This continues until it finds a match. If nothing matches, it always falls back to index.php.

i. For example for a **single post** it checks:
single-{post-type}.php → single.php → index.php

ii. For a **page** it checks:
page-{slug}.php → page-{id}.php → page.php → index.php

iii. For a **category** it checks:
category-{slug}.php → category.php → archive.php → index.php

This system gives developers control to create specific templates for specific pages while still having a general fallback for everything else.

We can see the full visual diagram of this at **wphierarchy.com**.